

Under Graduate Semester III Examination 2025–26 (NEP)

ENGLISH

Paper Code: ENGMD31 : Fantasy and Science Fiction

Time: 2:30 Hours

Full Marks: 70

Note: Answer all Sections as per instructions.

SECTION – A (Long Answer Type Questions)

Answer the following questions in about 400 words each: [3 × 12 = 36 Marks]

1. Describe the historical evolution of Fantasy and Science Fiction as distinct literary genres.

OR

Analyse the impact of time travel and artificial intelligence on the imaginative scope of science fiction narratives.

2. Devakinandan Khatri's *Chandrakanta* is a foundational work in Indian fantasy fiction. Elaborate with examples from the text.

OR

How does Angela Carter's *The Snow Child* reinterpret the traditional fairy tale from a feminist perspective?

3. Evaluate Arthur C. Clarke's *2001: A Space Odyssey* as a milestone in Science Fiction literature.

OR

Examine Ray Bradbury's *Mars Is Heaven!* as a Science Fiction narrative.

SECTION – B (Medium Answer Type Questions)

Answer the following questions in about 150 words each: [4 × 6 = 24 Marks]

1. Write a short and concise note on parallel universes with suitable examples.

OR

Explain in brief the term 'alien' with reference to Ray Bradbury's *Mars Is Heaven!*.

2. *The Snow Child* is a tale that interweaves hope, grief, loss, and survival. Explain.

OR

Write a short note on the idea of apocalypse.

3. In what ways does *Chandrakanta* preserve its sense of realism within its fantastical narrative?

OR

What is the scope of virtual reality in Science Fiction literature?

4. Examine the theme of illusion and reality in *Mars Is Heaven!*.

OR

2001: A Space Odyssey presents an ambivalent portrayal of technology. While it celebrates scientific innovation, it simultaneously warns against uncontrolled technological progress. Discuss.

SECTION – C (Short Answer Type Questions)

Answer any five of the following questions in about 50 words each: [5 × 2 = 10 Marks]

1. (a) Who are 'aiyars' in *Chandrakanta*?
- (b) How does Poolicoe die?
- (c) What do you understand by the term 'wizardry'?
- (d) Who is Moon-Watcher?
- (e) Define in one sentence what is teleportation.
- (f) What does *The Snow Child* symbolise?
- (g) Who are the central lovers around whom the plot of *Chandrakanta* revolves?